

CRESTLINE RETAIL GROUP

Sales Performance & Financial Analysis

2014 – 2017 | Retail Performance Analytics

Revenue & Profitability · Product & Region · Customer & Demand · Operations

Executive performance review prepared for management planning

SIMULATED PORTFOLIO CASE

Crestline Retail Group is a fictional company. The analysis uses a public historical sample dataset.

Contents

Executive management report · Ten pages · 2014–2017 historical analysis

01	Executive Summary	Growth strengthened, but profitability varied sharply	3
02	Sales Growth & Profitability	Two years of expansion with moderating profit growth	4
03	Product & Category Profitability	Furniture revenue scale masked a 2.49% margin	5
04	Regional Performance	West led on scale and margin; Central lagged	6
05	Customer, Discount & Demand Profile	Revenue leadership, discount bands and late-year demand	7
06	Management Priorities & Conclusion	Five evidence-based priorities	8
APPENDIX			
A	Basis of Analysis & Methodology	Architecture, validation controls, limitations and scenario disclosure	9

Growth Strengthened, but Profitability Varied Sharply Across the Business

Historical results, 2014–2017 · 9,994 transaction lines · 5,009 unique orders · All figures reconciled to the source workbook

\$2.30M TOTAL SALES	\$286K TOTAL PROFIT	+20.36% SALES GROWTH	5,009 UNIQUE ORDERS	\$458.61 AVERAGE ORDER VALUE
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PERFORMANCE & PROFITABILITY 2017 was the strongest year - Sales grew 29.47% in 2016 and 20.36% in 2017 - Technology 17.40% and Office Supplies 17.04% margins - Furniture margin of only 2.49% on \$742,000 of sales	CUSTOMERS & DEMAND - The highest-sales customer generated \$25,043 of sales but a \$1,981 loss - Home Office produced the highest segment margin at 14.03% 51.6% of sales fell in September–December - Transactions discounted above 20% carried negative aggregate margins	MANAGEMENT PRIORITIES - Improve Furniture profitability - Strengthen discount controls - Address Central-region margin pressure - Plan capacity around late-year demand - Add customer profitability to account reviews
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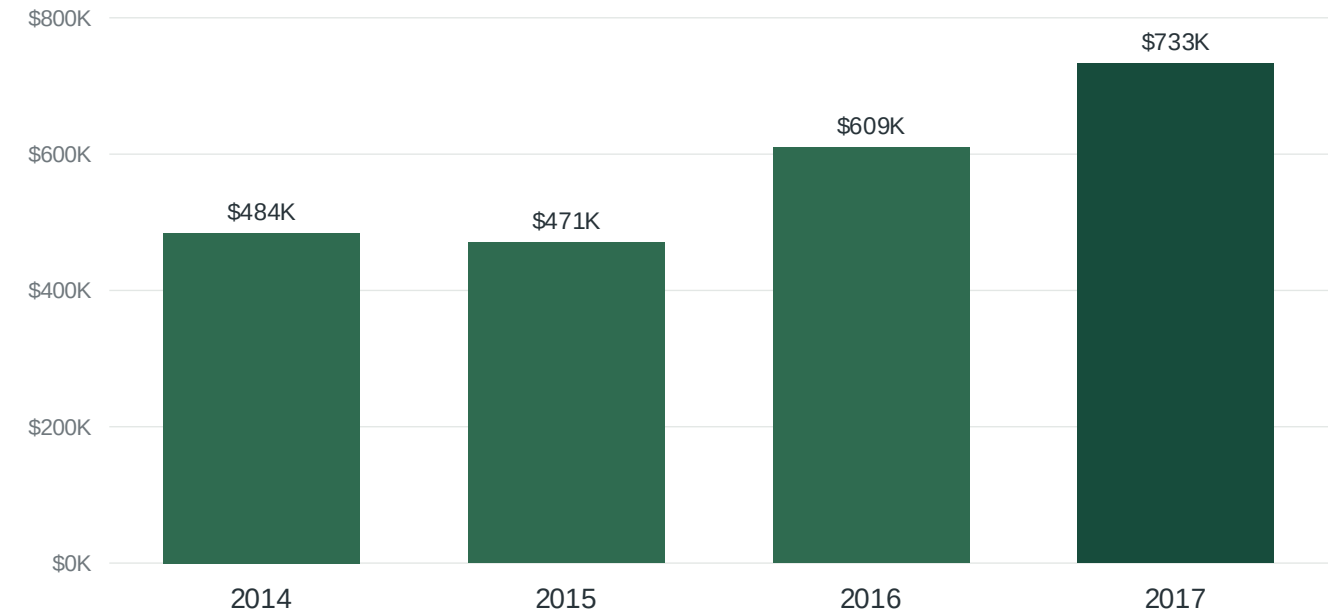
THE MANAGEMENT QUESTION How can Crestline sustain sales growth while improving profitability across products, regions, customers and operating periods?	3.96 days AVERAGE SHIPPING TIME	12.47% OVERALL MARGIN
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02 · Sales Growth & Profitability

Sales Accelerated in 2016–2017 While Profit Growth Moderated in 2017

Annual sales and profit, order date basis · Growth rates calculated year over year

ANNUAL SALES · 2014–2017



Total sales of \$2,297,201 and total profit of \$286,397 over the four-year period. Profit increased in every year.

YEAR-OVER-YEAR GROWTH

YEAR	SALES	SALES Δ	PROFIT Δ
2014	\$484,247	—	—
2015	\$470,533	−2.83%	+24.37%
2016	\$609,206	+29.47%	+32.74%
2017	\$733,215	+20.36%	+14.24%

+29.47%

2016 SALES GROWTH

+20.36%

2017 SALES GROWTH

Profit growth slowed from +32.74% (2016) to +14.24% (2017)

ANALYST INTERPRETATION

The business moved from a modest 2.83% sales decline in 2015 into two years of strong expansion. Profit rose every year, but the slower 2017 profit-growth rate shows topline growth did not translate into equally rapid profit expansion.

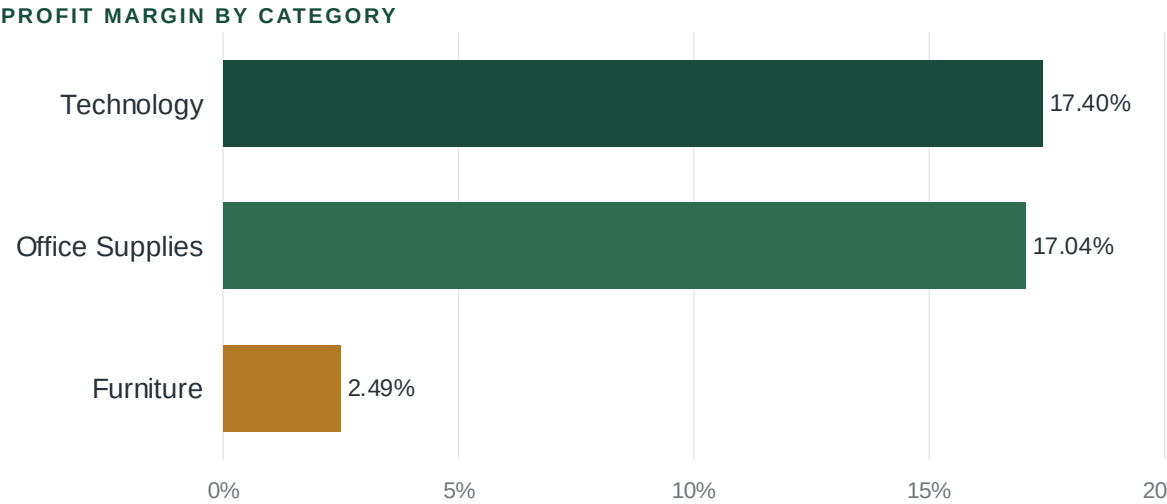
MANAGEMENT CONSIDERATION

Continue monitoring sales growth alongside profit and margin rather than treating revenue growth alone as the primary performance signal. No cause for the slower profit growth is measurable in this dataset.

03 · Product & Category Profitability

Furniture Generated Substantial Revenue but Only a 2.49% Margin

Profit margin by category, 2014–2017 · Margin = profit ÷ sales on line-level transactions



Technology led both sales and profit. Furniture ranked second on revenue yet contributed only \$18,451 of the \$286,397 total profit.

SALES AND PROFIT BY CATEGORY

CATEGORY	SALES	PROFIT	MARGIN
Technology	\$836,154	\$145,455	17.40%
Office Supplies	\$719,047	\$122,491	17.04%
Furniture	\$742,000	\$18,451	2.49%

LOSS-MAKING FURNITURE SUBCATEGORIES

-\$17,725

TABLES

-\$3,473

BOOKCASES

\$321K+

COMBINED SALES

Both subcategories produced aggregate losses despite generating more than \$321,000 of combined revenue.

ANALYST INTERPRETATION

Revenue scale masked a material profitability gap. Technology and Office Supplies produced margins near 17%, while Furniture generated comparable revenue with very little profit — and two of its subcategories were loss-making in aggregate.

MANAGEMENT CONSIDERATION

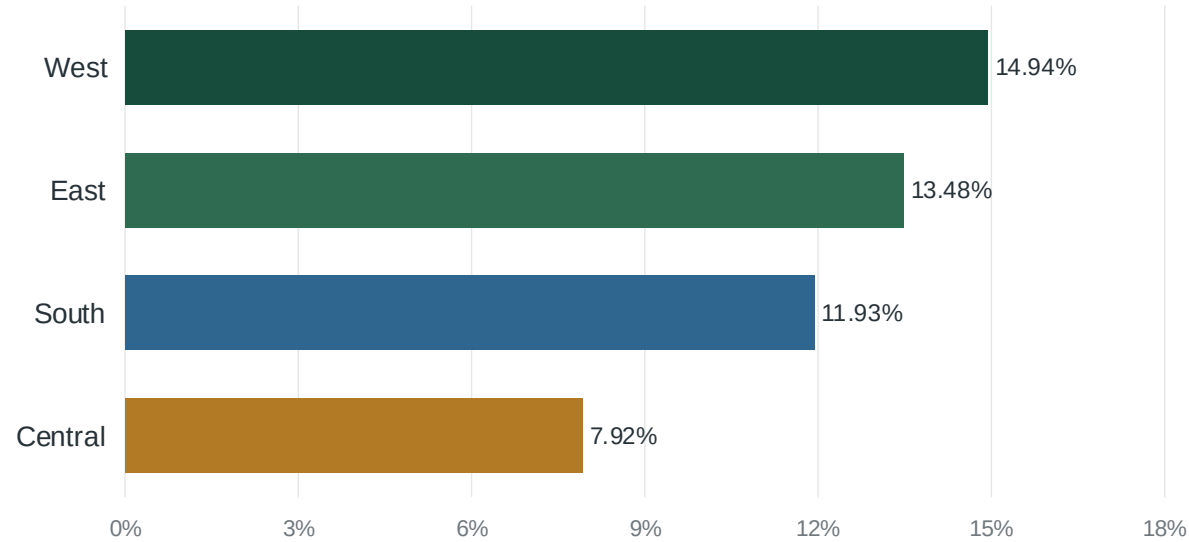
Review Furniture pricing, available cost drivers, product and customer mix, regional mix and discount practices — particularly for Tables and Bookcases — before prioritizing additional volume in the category.

04 · REGIONAL PERFORMANCE

West Led on Both Scale and Margin; Central Showed the Clearest Profitability Gap

Sales, profit and margin by region, 2014–2017 · Regions ranked by profit margin

PROFIT MARGIN BY REGION



Note: West and Central figures are the validated project evidence; East and South are calculated on the same basis from the source workbook.

REGIONAL SALES AND PROFIT

REGION	SALES	PROFIT	MARGIN
West	\$725,458	\$108,418	14.94%
East	\$678,781	\$91,523	13.48%
South	\$391,722	\$46,749	11.93%
Central	\$501,240	\$39,706	7.92%

7.02 pp

WEST vs. CENTRAL MARGIN GAP

Central ranked third on revenue but last of the four regions on margin.

ANALYST INTERPRETATION

Regional standing changed materially depending on whether performance was judged by revenue or by profitability. Central generated meaningful revenue — more than South — yet delivered the lowest margin of the four regions.

MANAGEMENT CONSIDERATION

Compare Central with the stronger regions on product mix, discounting, customer mix and available fulfillment and operating information to isolate actionable sources of the gap before setting regional targets.

05 · Customer, Discount & Demand Profile

Revenue Leadership Did Not Guarantee Profitability, and Demand Peaked Late in the Year

Four commercial perspectives from the same 2014–2017 transaction base

01 CUSTOMER PROFITABILITY

\$25,043

SALES · RANK 1

-\$1,981

PROFIT

The highest-sales customer of the period was unprofitable, while several smaller accounts returned strong margins. Revenue ranking alone can obscure account economics.

02 DISCOUNT SIGNAL

+21.80%

MARGIN · DISCOUNT ≤ 20%

-37.32%

MARGIN · DISCOUNT > 20%

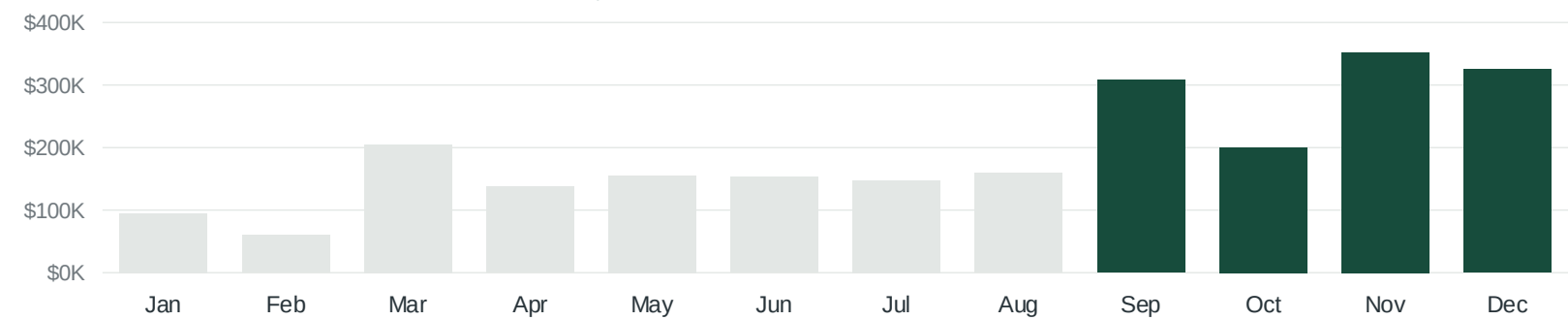
Transactions discounted above 20% produced negative aggregate margins. This is an observed historical association and does not establish that discounting alone caused the losses.

03 SEGMENT CONTEXT

Consumer	50.56% of sales	11.55%
Corporate	30.74% of sales	13.03%
Home Office	18.70% of sales	14.03%

Consumer led on volume; Home Office produced the strongest margin.

04 DEMAND CONCENTRATION · MONTHLY SALES, FOUR YEARS COMBINED



51.6%

OF SALES FELL SEPTEMBER–DECEMBER

November

HIGHEST-SALES MONTH IN PERIOD

ANALYST INTERPRETATION

Customer and discount results show that headline volume can diverge from profitability, while segment and monthly views add context around customer mix and late-year demand concentration.

MANAGEMENT CONSIDERATION

Add customer profitability and discount behavior to account reviews, monitor discount thresholds by category and customer, and prepare staffing, shipping, working-capital and service capacity ahead of peak months.

Five Evidence-Based Priorities for Future Retail Performance Management

Each priority is tied to a validated historical observation from the 2014–2017 analysis

PRIORITY	MANAGEMENT CONSIDERATION	EVIDENCE	HORIZON
1 Improve Furniture profitability	Review Tables and Bookcases by product, customer, region, discount level, pricing and available cost drivers before prioritizing additional volume.	2.49% Furniture margin; Tables –\$17,725 and Bookcases –\$3,473 in aggregate	Near-term
2 Strengthen discount controls	Consider discount monitoring and approval thresholds, and analyze discount performance by category and customer to test what explains the negative margins.	Transactions discounted above 20% produced negative aggregate margins	Near-term
3 Address Central-region margin pressure	Compare Central with stronger regions on product mix, discounting, customer mix and available fulfillment and operating information.	7.92% Central margin vs. 14.94% West — a 7.02 pp gap	Next planning cycle
4 Plan capacity around late-year demand	Use the recurring September–December concentration to inform staffing, shipping capacity, working capital and customer-service resourcing.	~51.6% of four-year sales fell in September–December	Annual / pre-peak
5 Add customer profitability to account reviews	Evaluate major accounts on sales, profit, margin, order frequency and discount behavior rather than ranking them by revenue alone.	Highest-sales customer generated \$25,043 of sales and a \$1,981 loss	Ongoing

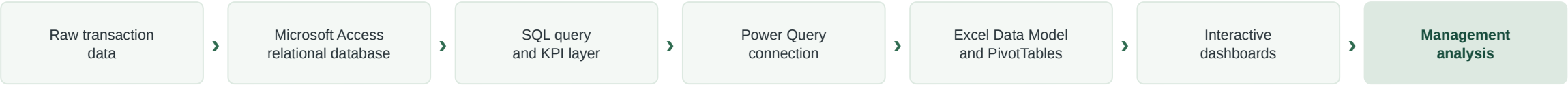
CONCLUSION

Crestline's historical results show strong late-period growth, but future performance management should focus more explicitly on margin quality, customer economics, discount discipline, regional profitability and peak-season readiness. These priorities rest on historical descriptive evidence and are intended to guide further investigation — they are not presented as guaranteed sources of financial improvement, and no financial impact is claimed.

APPENDIX A

Basis of Analysis & Methodology

Analytical architecture, validation controls, limitations and scenario disclosure



SOURCE AND REPORTING BASIS

ANALYTICAL AREA	PERIOD / BASIS	SOURCE / GRAIN	STATUS
Sales, profit, margin	2014–2017, order date	Line-level order detail	Reconciled
Orders and AOV	2014–2017	Distinct OrderID	Reconciled
Category and subcategory	Four-year aggregate	Line level via ProductKey	Reconciled
Region and segment	Four-year aggregate	Line level via customer/order	Reconciled
Shipping time	2014–2017	Order grain	Reconciled
Discount bands	Four-year aggregate	Line-level discount rate	Descriptive

Core basis: 9,994 transaction lines · 5,009 unique orders · public historical sample dataset · fictional management scenario · historical descriptive analysis.

KNOWN LIMITATIONS

Public sample data and a fictional company. The analysis is historical and descriptive. The dataset contains no complete product-cost detail beyond the profit measure, no inventory levels, no marketing activity, no customer acquisition cost, no service-quality information and no external market context. Forecasting, predictive modeling, customer lifetime value and inventory optimization are outside the scope of this work. Observed historical relationships do not establish causation.

MODELING AND VALIDATION CONTROLS

- The original ProductID was not sufficiently unique for the intended relational model; a surrogate ProductKey was introduced.
- Total Orders calculated as a distinct count of OrderID, not a line-item count (9,994 lines vs. 5,009 orders).
- Average Order Value defined as total sales ÷ unique orders; average shipping time calculated at order grain.
- SQL joins checked to confirm they did not multiply transaction records.
- Sales and profit reconciled across source data, database and workbook.
- Seven slicers tested across 11 connected PivotTables; full Power Query refresh checked for formula and connection errors.

SCENARIO DISCLOSURE

Crestline Retail Group is fictional. This is a simulated portfolio case using public historical sample data. No recommendation should be interpreted as having been implemented, and no unsupported financial impact is claimed.

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